

Acme Corporation

Information Technology Security & Acceptable Use Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes the minimum security standards and acceptable use requirements for all employees, contractors, and third-party vendors who access Acme Corporation's information systems, networks, and data. It applies to all company-owned and personally owned devices used to conduct company business, whether on-premises, remote, or hybrid.

This document is reviewed annually by the Information Security Office and supersedes all previous versions upon publication. Employees are required to acknowledge this policy during onboarding and upon each material revision.

2. Password and Authentication Requirements

All employees must comply with the following authentication standards when accessing Acme systems:

- Passwords must be a minimum of 14 characters and include at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all remote access, VPN connections, and cloud application logins (Okta, Google Workspace, AWS Console).
- Passwords must not be reused across the last 10 password cycles.
- Shared or generic accounts are prohibited except where explicitly approved by the Information Security Office for service accounts.
- Employees must report suspected credential compromise to the Security Operations Center (SOC) within 1 hour of discovery.

3. Data Classification Standards

All company data must be classified according to the following tiers. Handling, storage, and transmission requirements vary by classification level as summarized below.

Classification	Description	Examples	Encryption Required
Public	Approved for external release	Marketing materials, press releases	No
Internal	For employee use only, low sensitivity	Internal memos, org charts	No
Confidential	Sensitive business information	Financial reports, contracts, source code	Yes (at rest & in transit)

Restricted	Highest sensitivity, regulated data	Customer PII, payment data, health records	Yes (mandatory, audited)
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4. Acceptable Use of Company Systems

Company systems, including laptops, mobile devices, email, and cloud storage, are provided for business purposes. Limited personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with job performance, consume excessive resources, or violate any provision of this policy.

4.1 Prohibited Activities

- Installing unauthorized software or browser extensions on company-managed devices.
- Transmitting Confidential or Restricted data to personal email accounts or unapproved cloud storage services.
- Disabling or circumventing endpoint security agents, VPN clients, or device management profiles.
- Using company systems to access, store, or distribute unlicensed or infringing content.
- Connecting unapproved USB storage devices to systems that process Restricted data.

5. Incident Reporting and Response

Any suspected security incident, including phishing attempts, malware infections, lost or stolen devices, or unauthorized access, must be reported immediately to the Security Operations Center at soc@acmecorp-internal.example or via the internal Incident Portal. Do not attempt to independently investigate or remediate a suspected breach.

Target response times are as follows: Critical incidents (active data exfiltration, ransomware) — 15 minutes; High severity (confirmed malware, account compromise) — 1 hour; Medium severity (policy violations, suspicious activity) — 4 business hours; Low severity (informational reports) — 2 business days.

6. Remote Work and Device Security

Employees working remotely must connect to company systems exclusively through the approved VPN client and must not use public, unsecured Wi-Fi networks to access Confidential or Restricted data without VPN protection. All company-issued laptops must have full-disk encryption, endpoint detection and response (EDR) software, and automatic screen locking after 5 minutes of inactivity enabled at all times.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)	Owns this policy; approves annual revisions and exceptions
Security Operations Center (SOC)	Monitors, triages, and responds to security incidents 24/7
IT Helpdesk	Provisions accounts, enforces MFA enrollment, manages device compliance
People Managers	Ensure direct reports complete annual security training and policy acknowledgment
All Employees	Comply with this policy and report suspected incidents promptly

8. Enforcement and Exceptions

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment or contract, and may be reported to law enforcement where required by law. Exceptions to this policy must be requested in writing to the Information Security Office and are granted only for a defined period with compensating controls documented.

9. Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Changes
3.2	2026-01-15	Updated MFA requirements to include cloud console access
3.1	2025-06-01	Added remote work Wi-Fi restrictions section
3.0	2024-11-20	Full rewrite aligned to ISO 27001:2022 controls
2.4	2023-09-10	Minor clarifications to data classification table

This document is classified Internal Use Only and is not for external distribution. For questions, contact the Information Security Office at infosec@acmecorp-internal.example.